

Crime na
QUINTA das
LÁGRIMAS

Crime at Quinta das Lágrimas

A partnership between
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GALGO
FILMES

Title: Crime na Quinta das Lágrimas

Genre: Crime Drama

Language: Portuguese and Spanish

Format: 6 x 45'

Based on the novel by: Lourenço Seruya

Screenplay: Sara Rodi



When Alice and Diego chose the Quinta das Lágrimas to celebrate their wedding, they had no idea of the tragedy that was about to strike their lives.

That winter week, with the hotel reserved exclusively for the bride and groom, their families and friends, everything pointed to a dream wedding. But on the morning of the ceremony, the guests wake up in shock: the bride has vanished, and her body lies in the Fonte das Lágrimas.

The case is handed over to the country's most high-profile inspector.





A murder investigation wrapped in a web of lies.
The police race against time to uncover the truth.
Will they manage to do it in time to prevent more deaths?

A mystery and murder crime series
based on the literary phenomenon
“Crime na Quinta das Lágrimas”
by Lourenço Seruya

SYNOPSIS





A renowned Spanish plastic surgeon — **Diego Santiago** — and a Portuguese visual artist — **Alice Vargas** — reserve the **Quinta das Lágrimas**, in Coimbra, for their wedding ceremony. But the event ends in tragedy: on the morning of the wedding, the bride is found dead in the **Fonte das Lágrimas**.

Since no one besides the bride and groom, the guests, and the hotel staff entered or left the premises, the two detectives assigned to the case — **Bruno Saraiva** and **Carolina Camacho** — must focus their investigation on those inside to uncover the killer.

Bruno is a well-known investigator in the Portuguese Judiciary Police. He was working on a case in Lisbon when an assailant left him near death, setting fire to the theatre he was in. After months of recovery, Bruno felt the need to leave Lisbon and transferred to Coimbra, settling in shortly before the murder at the Quinta das Lágrimas. Psychologically, Bruno still bears scars, and the fact that he is widely recognized — even by some of the journalists covering the case — makes it hard for him to stay grounded.

Carolina, an experienced inspector herself, is brought in to work with Bruno, which initially intimidates her. Her attempts to connect are awkward, and it is only throughout the investigation that the two grow closer... and fall in love. Carolina, stuck in an abusive relationship, decides to leave it behind, and Bruno — who never imagined he could forget his past — finds in her someone capable of helping him heal.

Diego, heir to a great fortune, met Alice at a painting exhibition she held in Spain. He ended up buying most of the artworks to decorate his clinic. Alice tried to resist Diego's charm for a while, but they eventually started dating — a relationship they chose to formalize at the Quinta das Lágrimas.

Diego invited his aunt and uncle, who raised him after his parents' death, and his best friend, who would be his best man.

Alice, also an orphan, invited her grandmother, her sister, and her two closest friends.

But everyone carries secrets — and one by one, they'll be exposed.
After all, who killed Alice?

And she won't be the only one to die at the **Quinta das Lágrimas...**



EPISODE SUMMARY

EPISODE 1 – One Dead. Who Died?

Winter dawn in Coimbra. At the Quinta das Lágrimas, a body is found in the fountain that carries the tragic legend of Inês de Castro. Inspector Bruno Saraiva stares at the scene, his gaze hardened. He touches the freezing water with a hand covered in scars.

One day earlier, the hotel was buzzing with preparations for the wedding of Spanish plastic surgeon Diego Santiago and Portuguese artist Alice Vargas. Among family and friends, the idyllic atmosphere hides tensions: suspicions, jealousy, secrets, and old wounds.

Camila, the bride's sister, reveals that Diego tried to kiss her; André, Alice's ex-boyfriend, still hopes to win her back; Beatriz, the maid of honour, watches everything in guilty silence.

Meanwhile, Bruno is trying to adjust to life at the Coimbra police department, his new post after months in hospital recovering from serious burns — both physical and emotional — following his last case.

He's introduced to the inspector he'll be partnering with, Carolina Camacho, but treats her coldly. Carolina only wants to be friendly, but Bruno isn't ready to let anyone in.

On the eve of the wedding, a family dinner turns into a battlefield of hidden emotions, where everyone seems to be hiding something.

At dawn, Bruno and Carolina are called to a new case: a body has been found at the Quinta das Lágrimas.

When it is pulled from the water, the truth sends shockwaves through the guests — the victim is Alice, the bride.





EPISODE 2 – Everyone's a Suspect

On the morning of the wedding, Beatriz wakes up early and tries to call Alice to make sure she's awake — but there's no answer. The bride's room is empty, the bed untouched. Worry turns to panic when, after searching the gardens, Alice's body is found in the Fonte das Lágrimas. Inspectors Bruno Saraiva and Carolina Camacho take over the investigation. The pathologist confirms: it was murder.

Among guests and family, the shock is overwhelming. Nine people were at the hotel that night, and all have something to hide:

Diego, the devastated groom;

Camila, the resentful sister;

André, the lovesick ex-boyfriend;

Beatriz, the best friend;

Eduardo and Gloria, the uncles;

Maria Adelaide, the grandmother; and

Tomás, the best man — all become suspects.

As Bruno and Carolina attempt to piece together Alice's final hours, the first contradictions emerge. Someone is lying — but who?

With the hotel in lockdown and the tension rising, one thing becomes clear: the killer is among them.

And everyone, without exception, is a suspect.



EPISODE 3 – Crossed Clues

Bruno and Carolina begin a thorough search of Alice's room. Everything seems untouched — except for one detail: the heirloom watch Alice was going to gift Diego, valued at 35,000 euros, is missing.

As the inspectors continue to reconstruct the victim's final hours, contradictions among the guests multiply and the mystery deepens. Then a new piece of information emerges: Alice was pregnant. Diego is in shock — he can't understand why she didn't tell him. Was the child his?

Meanwhile, security guard Sérgio reveals he saw Alice talking to someone near the Fonte das Lágrimas — a medium-height figure, wearing a brown hooded coat, whose identity remains unknown. The autopsy confirms it: Alice was strangled before being thrown into the water. Was it the hooded man or woman?

Amid new statements, rising suspicions and overlapping clues, Bruno slowly begins to open up to Carolina, revealing fragments of his tragic past.

And just when they think they've seen it all, a chilling twist: something has been found in Maria Adelaide's room. Even more disturbing — Rafael, the hotel receptionist, confesses that he saw Alice's grandmother entering her room after the body had already been discovered.



EPISODE 4 – Silenced Truths

As the pressure mounts, secrets from Alice's family begin to surface. Maria Adelaide is interrogated and denies having been with her granddaughter on the night of the crime — but eventually admits she entered Alice's room after her death, claiming she only wanted to retrieve the heirloom watch, which she says was stolen afterwards.

Meanwhile, Camila tries to blackmail André, revealing she overheard the violent argument he had with Alice before the wedding. Under pressure, André confesses to the inspectors that he threatened Alice — but insists he's innocent.

Tension rises when the root of Camila's resentment is uncovered: an old tragedy — the fire that killed their parents, started accidentally by Alice when she was a child.

As DNA samples are collected and evidence piles up, Bruno and Carolina pursue new leads. The missing watch is finally found in the garden — but the fingerprints on it raise more questions than answers.

While the relationship between the two inspectors grows closer — and more strained — another twist shakes the Quinta das Lágrimas: a second body is found.





EPISODE 5 – A New Crime

Shock once again descends over the Quinta das Lágrimas: Rafael is found dead in Eduardo and Gloria's room, brutally attacked with a golf club. The couple is the first to be interrogated, but deny any involvement. Rafael had been called to the room to deal with a wasp, but the call turns out to have been a trap. Guilherme, devastated, confesses that his colleague had been terrified since witnessing something he shouldn't have — and now, that fear has turned fatal.

Among suspects and secrets, detectives Bruno and Carolina realise the killer acted in broad daylight, even with the police present. Who had so much to lose that they dared to kill so boldly? Was it the same person who murdered Alice?

Tension rises among the guests, masks begin to fall, and unexpected alliances form.

Meanwhile, a new lead emerges: Alice may have visited the Quinta before — and not alone. Who was with her?

As the investigation progresses, Bruno and Carolina grow closer — and nothing will ever be the same again.





EPISODE 6 – Truth Delayed

Tension at the Quinta das Lágrimas reaches a breaking point. Bruno and Carolina revisit the pasts of Alice and Beatriz, uncovering that they had a romantic relationship. But not all secrets have come to light.

Diego disappears, triggering a frantic search through the hotel's rooms and gardens. A golf club and slightly open windows suggest a cruel, premeditated plan. Gloria and Eduardo, hiding financial and personal motives, are revealed to be behind the string of crimes — including the murders of Alice, Rafael, and ultimately Diego, confirmed through DNA evidence.

With the arrests made and the truth finally exposed, justice is served. But the emotional fallout lingers.

Three weeks later, Bruno and Carolina walk the grounds of the Quinta das Lágrimas. The case is closed, but the scars remain. Only hope endures — that not all love stories must end in tragedy.

CHARACTER DESCRIPTION

Calm, reserved and detail-oriented, Bruno is regarded by all as an excellent inspector in the Criminal Investigation Police. Empathetic and with a strong sense of justice, he knows how to put himself in the victims' shoes — perhaps due to his own personal experiences of loss — and never gives up until he helps them. This explains his almost obsessive dedication to work, which has already cost him relationships and personal balance.

Although he is a good-looking man, he hides under his clothes the scars he earned in the last case he worked on — one that nearly cost him his life. He values being alive, and enjoys life's simple pleasures, like food, but keeps in shape with a daily run that also helps him stay focused and relieve the emotional weight of the job.

His previous case brought him media exposure he despises and believes undermines his work. He moved to Coimbra to escape the spotlight, but the murder at Quinta das Lágrimas thrusts him right back into it. Uncomfortable with the attention, he initially struggles to connect with Carolina, his new partner. But little by little, he learns to trust her — and the two eventually grow close.

BRUNO SARAIVA
32 Y.O. (PT)



DIEGO SANTIAGO,
32 Y.P (SP)

Rich, handsome, confident, and charismatic, Diego is the portrait of apparent perfection. A plastic surgeon with a renowned clinic in Spain, he is also the heir to a fortune left by his parents, who died seven years earlier in a tragic plane crash in the Swiss Alps.

At that time, his greatest support came from his aunt and uncle, Gloria and Eduardo, with whom Diego has a very close relationship.

However, his true foundation is Alice, the woman he chose to share his life with. He met her two years earlier in Spain at an art exhibition and was enchanted by her simplicity and serenity. They shared the fact that both were orphans, which brought them even closer.

They have been dating discreetly ever since, between Spain and Portugal, until they decided to get married at the Quinta das Lágrimas, where their relationship was first made official.

Like Alice, Diego is a reserved person, especially when it comes to his private life, which is why he decided to have a wedding away from the media spotlight, inviting only his closest family and his best friend — Tomás, chosen to be the best man — to a closed and private location. Diego is extremely generous with those he loves, but ruthless with those who betray him, becoming cold, calculating, and vengeful in such moments.

A restless soul and visual artist, Alice graduated in Fine Arts and spends her days surrounded by canvases and brushes in her studio in Lisbon's Bairro Alto. Orphaned since the age of eight, she carries the weight of the tragedy that marked her childhood: the death of her parents in a gas explosion, after she had unknowingly tampered with the stove knobs. Although it was an unconscious act, her sister Camila never fully forgave her and never misses an opportunity to make her feel guilty.

Alice and Camila were raised by their paternal grandmother, Maria Adelaide, a conservative woman who doesn't always understand the choices her granddaughters make. Alice handles this disapproval well — she either laughs it off or ignores it, maintaining affection for her grandmother nonetheless.

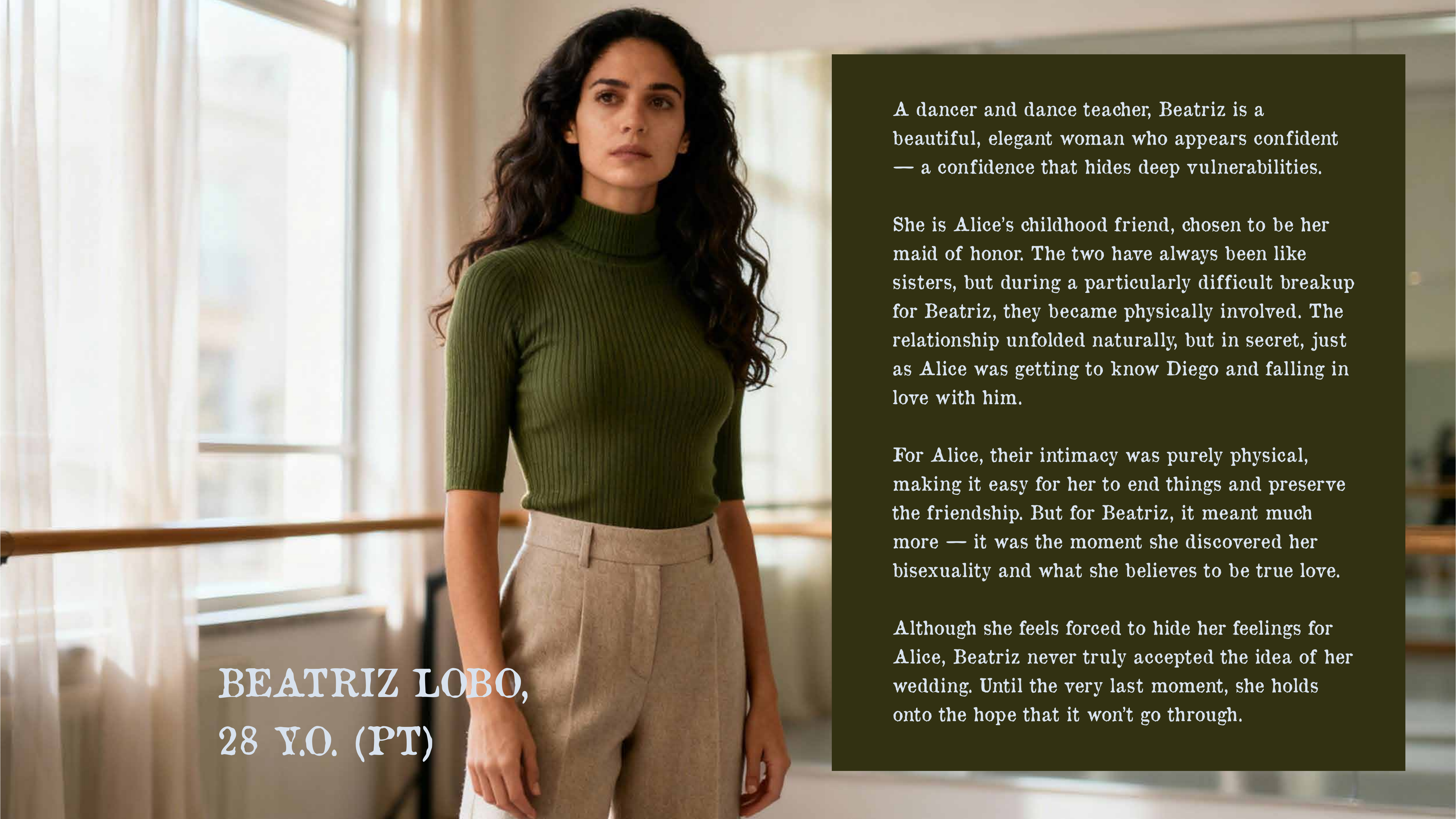
Alice has always enjoyed solitude, preferably in nature, but shares her life with a close friend — Beatriz, whom she invited to be her maid of honor. Alice and Beatriz were briefly involved physically, something Alice ended gently when she began dating Diego Santiago. She never truly wanted a serious relationship with her best friend but approached that experience naturally, even though it was a same-sex relationship. Alice is free of prejudice but is private enough to have never spoken about it to anyone.

She met Diego in Spain at an art exhibition. Initially hesitant to let him into her life due to her need for solitude, she was won over by how he never made her feel pressured. He loved her but gave her the space she needed — perhaps because he lived in Spain and had a busy professional life. This freedom allowed Alice to gradually open up until she finally agreed to marry him. Diego offered her a sense of trust and calm she had never felt in any previous relationship — not even with André, her ex-boyfriend, now just a good friend.

But the wedding will never take place...



ALICE VARGAS,
28 Y.O. (PT)



BEATRIZ LOBO,
28 Y.O. (PT)

A dancer and dance teacher, Beatriz is a beautiful, elegant woman who appears confident — a confidence that hides deep vulnerabilities.

She is Alice's childhood friend, chosen to be her maid of honor. The two have always been like sisters, but during a particularly difficult breakup for Beatriz, they became physically involved. The relationship unfolded naturally, but in secret, just as Alice was getting to know Diego and falling in love with him.

For Alice, their intimacy was purely physical, making it easy for her to end things and preserve the friendship. But for Beatriz, it meant much more — it was the moment she discovered her bisexuality and what she believes to be true love.

Although she feels forced to hide her feelings for Alice, Beatriz never truly accepted the idea of her wedding. Until the very last moment, she holds onto the hope that it won't go through.

Manager of a bar in Bairro Alto, André is a laid-back and naturally handsome man, though he doesn't pay much attention to his appearance. He dated Alice for three years and, although the relationship ended some time ago, he's never truly fallen in love with anyone else since. He maintains a friendly relationship with her — Alice still visits the bar once or twice a week to talk and have a drink.

Just days before the wedding, when he sees her in a bridal gown, he realizes he's still in love and asks her to run away with him. Alice is stunned: she moved on from André a long time ago and now loves Diego, the man she wants to marry. Despite feeling heartbroken and rejected, André doesn't skip the wedding. Deep down, he still hopes Alice might change her mind.

ANDRÉ CUNHA,
29 Y.O. (PT)

Grandmother to Alice and Camila, Maria Adelaide is a woman who maintains a conservative and age-appropriate appearance.

Strong and determined, she has endured a great deal in life, but nothing seems to break her. Widowed many years ago, she also lost her son in a gas explosion and took on the responsibility of raising her two young granddaughters.

She holds a traditional worldview, shaped by strict, old-fashioned morals, which makes her highly critical of the “missteps” of youth. She had very different aspirations for her granddaughters — Alice is an artist, Camila never married — and she hasn’t given up on trying to “set them straight.”

Though pleased about Alice’s marriage to Diego, she’s uneasy about her granddaughter’s close friendship with Beatriz (suspecting there’s more to it) and disapproves of Alice inviting her ex-boyfriend André to the wedding. Deep down, she fears something might ruin the marriage — a fear that sadly comes true, in the most tragic way.

MARIA ADELAIDE VARGAS,
81 Y.O. (PT)



TOMÁS ARAGÓN,
32 Y.O. (SP)

Handsome, charming, and naturally persuasive, Tomás is a true Don Juan.

He can't resist the sight of a beautiful woman — his instinct is always to seduce — and it's rare for him to end a night alone. He never aspired to marry or have children, viewing commitment as suffocating. He doesn't believe in the idea of happiness tied to a lifelong monogamous relationship.

He met Diego in boarding school, and they've been best friends ever since. Currently, Tomás works as the Chief Financial Officer at Diego's clinic, balancing their friendship with professional duties. Diego invited him to be the best man at his wedding.

Alice's older sister, Camila works as a public relations manager at a luxury restaurant.

Bitter and resentful, she has a strained relationship with her family — including her grandmother and sister — and harbors jealousy toward Alice's life and relationships. She blames Alice for their parents' death, even though she knows Alice was just a child at the time and suffered just as much.

She is also jealous of Beatriz and doesn't understand why Alice chose her as maid of honor, believing she herself would have been far more suitable.

When things don't go her way, Camila becomes manipulative and loses all sense of decency. She dreams of meeting a rich and handsome man like Diego, but her relationships always end in failure.



**CAMILA VARGAS,
35 Y.O. (PT)**



Diego's aunt and uncle treat him as if he were their own son — but their true motivation lies in his fortune.

Obsessed with money, they believe they are entitled to part of Diego's inheritance due to the support they gave him after his parents' death. They disapprove of his marriage to Alice, seeing her as a threat to what they consider “rightfully” theirs.

Gloria worked as an executive secretary at a law firm, while Eduardo owns a car dealership. Unlike his brother — Diego's father — who built a construction empire, Eduardo never had a talent for business and has accumulated debt after debt.

Constantly frustrated, he blames everyone else for his failures, which he refuses to admit, always presenting himself as a successful man.

**GLORIA AND EDUARDO SANTIAGO,
64 e 65 Y.O. (SP)**

A woman with dark hair tied back, wearing a black leather jacket over a dark button-down shirt and black pants. She has a police badge on her belt and is standing in front of a window with a blue and white tiled wall. The lighting is warm, coming from the window.

CAROLINA CAMACHO, 33 Y.O. (PT)

Inspector at the Polícia Judiciária, Carolina has always worked hard to gain recognition in her field.

Dedicated and perfectionist, she likes to have everything under control — something she manages only at work. In her personal life, she is involved in a turbulent romantic relationship, marked by jealousy and mistrust, which leaves her emotionally unsettled.

When she is assigned Bruno as her partner, Carolina doesn't know what to expect. She followed his case in Lisbon and knows he's a highly experienced professional, but when she tries to learn more about what happened to him — out of both professional curiosity and a desire to build a working relationship — he is cold and distant. Carolina finds it difficult to read him, which prevents her from feeling in control.

Over time, however, Bruno begins to trust her. And when Carolina finally ends her troubled relationship, the two of them eventually become romantically involved.



The director of the Quinta das Lágrimas hotel in Coimbra, she is a strong-willed, assertive woman with a commanding personality.

She built her career through hard work in a field traditionally dominated by men and values having absolute control over her work environment.

The crime that occurs at the hotel completely destabilizes the control she thought she had: the presence of the police makes her anxious and tense, and she fears the impact the case could have on her career.

MAGDA VASCONCELOS,
54 Y.O. (PT)



A young man with dark hair, smiling, wearing a white shirt, dark tie, and a dark blue vest with a name tag. He is standing in a grand, ornate hotel lobby with high ceilings and chandeliers.

**RAFAEL,
26 Y.O. (PT)**

Rafael has been working at the Quinta das Lágrimas hotel as a receptionist for two years, maintaining good relationships with all his colleagues — especially with Guilherme, who supported him when he first started.

He is friendly, attentive, and helpful, and always tries to do what he believes is right, even at the risk of being punished for it.

When confronted with a murder at his workplace — something for which he was completely unprepared — Rafael finds himself torn by moral dilemmas.

In the end, the truth will cost him his own life.

**GUILHERME,
32 Y.O. (PT)**

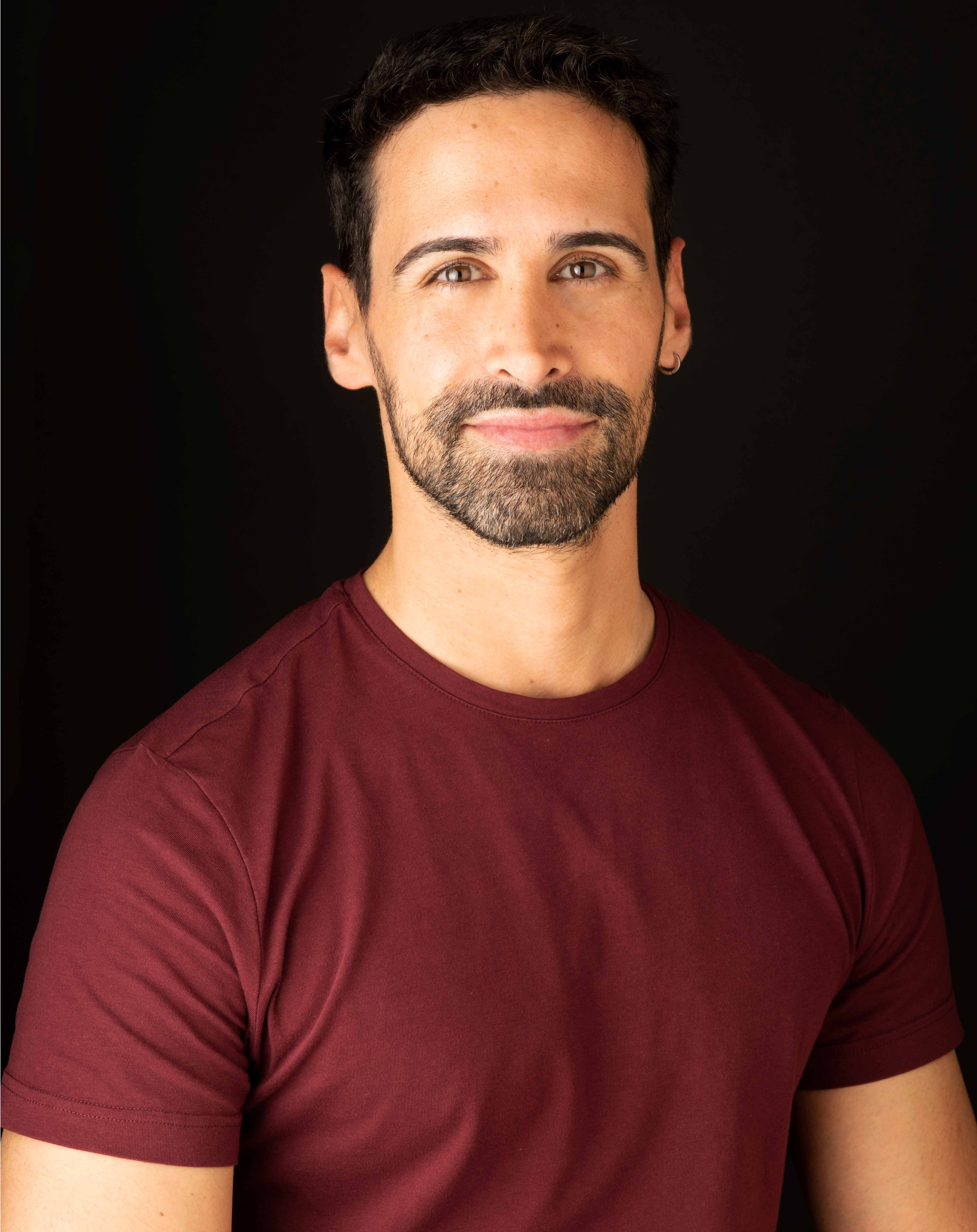
Guilherme has worked for several years at the Quinta das Lágrimas hotel, where he is known for his dedication and discretion. He was one of the first to support Rafael when he joined the team, developing a relationship of friendship and trust with him.

After Alice's death, Guilherme can't resist trying to understand what happened. He revisits the events and discusses them with his colleague Rafael. His sharp memory and keen insight prove very helpful to the investigation.

However, Guilherme also has to deal with pressure from his superiors — particularly from the hotel director, Magda, who is determined not to lose control of the situation.

Things escalate quickly after Rafael is murdered, and Guilherme fears he may be the next victim...

LOURENÇO SERUYA



Lourenço Seruya was born in Lisbon at the end of the 20th century. After a brief stint in the field of Communication, he completed the **ACT – School for Actors' Acting** Course in 2015. He has been working as an actor since 2011, with dozens of projects in theatre, television, and film.

Alongside acting, he teaches **Drama** and leads **team-building workshops** for companies through **Team Theatre**.

He debuted in crime fiction in 2021 with *A Mão que Mata* (now in its 4th edition), followed by *A Maldição* (2nd edition), *Crime na Quinta das Lágrimas* (4th edition), *Crime na Aldeia* (3rd edition), and *Morte nas Caves* (2nd edition).

All of his books have ranked in the national bestseller lists, including the **top 3 at Bertrand** (Portugal's leading bookstore chain), and he has sold over **35,000 copies**.

A regular presence at **literary fairs** from north to south of Portugal, he welcomes thousands of readers each year to sign books and talk about his stories. At the major fairs (Lisbon and Porto), he draws long queues, and his signing sessions can last up to **four hours**.

In addition to his writing career, he also teaches **Creative Writing**.

CRIME NA QUINTA DAS LÁGRIMAS

- 4th edition, 9 months after publication
- Rating of 4.31 on Goodreads – 2,152 reviews and 322 comments
- #7 on Bertrand's national bestseller list



SARA RODI

Graduated in Communication Sciences, she has been working since 2000 as a writer and screenwriter, writing and coordinating the writing of numerous soap operas and series for various audiences and channels. Some of her projects were book adaptations, notably *Uma Aventura* (2007) and *Escola das Artes* (2018), the latter based on her own book series.

Her most recent works include:

- *Sr. Rui – Um Homem do Povo* (2024)
- *Crimes Submersos* (Drought, 2022)
- *Lume* (2025)

The last two are crime dramas co-produced with Spanish companies and broadcast on national channels and streaming platforms.

In literary fiction, her notable novels include:

- *D. Estefânia – Um Trágico Amor* (3rd edition)
- *D. Teresa de Távora – A Amante do Rei* (2nd edition)
- *O Quanto Amei – Fernando Pessoa e as Mulheres da Sua Vida* (2nd edition)

She is a member of the **Clube das Mulheres Escritoras** and regularly speaks at events focused on **reading, education, and health**.

<https://sararodi.pt>



THANKS!